

GROWTH ARCHITECT

Under the deft guidance of Kushal N. Desai, APAR Industries seems well set on a profitable path thanks to its agility in doubling down on opportunities

By **Perna Lidhoo**

► **IN THE HEART** of Mumbai's bustling cityscape, 57-year-old Kushal Narendra Desai's influence reverberates far beyond the confines of his office in APAR House, nestled in Chembur.

Dressed in a crisp business suit radiating quiet strength, Desai powers APAR Industries' empire, which is spread across 140 countries. His demeanour may be soft-spoken and his presence unassuming, but his impact on the nation's infrastructure is considerable. Through the manufacturing of cables, industrial lubricants, specialty oils, and conductors, his firm is perhaps the silent force behind the grand edifices and sprawling projects that define the landscape.

"When one looks at a fancy-looking building, people appreciate the external things like the glass and signage. Our products are all hidden, but we do the bricks, the steel, and the network without which the

building can't stand," says Desai, Chairman & MD of APAR Industries, who is a third-generation businessman at the company founded in 1958 by his grandfather, Dharamsinh D. Desai.

Desai, who runs the company with his brother Chaitanya, who is the MD, likes to stay true to his company's name, which translates to 'limitless' in Sanskrit. "I firmly believe that we work on tomorrow's solutions today. That's what makes us limitless. There's always been a need to think out of the box," he says.

That thinking has helped it become the largest global manufacturer of aluminium and alloy conductors and the third-largest manufacturer of transformer oils. It has blockbuster projects like the INS Vikrant, India's first indigenous aircraft carrier, to its credit. It is also the largest supplier of cables for the flagship Vande Bharat trains and accounts for nearly 98% of the cables used in them.

Today, it caters to specialty sectors from the railways, naval ships, submarines, solar firms, windmills, telecom firms, etc., with a wide range of medium-voltage and low-voltage XLPE (or insulated), elastomeric (or rubber), specialty, and fibre-optic cables. It is the leader in India for specialty cables, with a 70% market share in the domestic wind energy sector. "We provide our customers solutions that tangibly solve their problems. As the market requirements advance, we have ensured that we have a product portfolio that is both relevant and leading the technology curve across our business verticals," he adds.

Experts point out that APAR's first and biggest business of conductors, which accounts for 47% of its revenues, is expected to grow by leaps and bounds. This is thanks to the growing demand for electricity, the focus on renewable energy, and the opportunity from the upgrade of the outdated power transmission infrastructure both in India and abroad.

In FY23, the company reported consolidated sales of ₹14,352 crore, against ₹9,316.57 crore in FY22, and a profit after tax (PAT) of ₹637.7 crore, compared with ₹256.73 crore in FY22. According to Prabhudas Lillad-

| 147

Infrastructure & Capital Goods

KUSHAL NARENDRA DESAI

CHAIRMAN & MD, APAR INDUSTRIES

Revenue from operations	FY23	14,352.2
	9MFY24	11,711.1
Profit before tax	FY23	854.6
	9MFY24	784.8
Profit after tax	FY23	637.7
	9MFY24	588.9
	FY23 RoE (%)	32.28
	Market Cap	25,277.9

● Data is on a consolidated basis; all figures in ₹ crore except RoE; 9MFY24: April-December 2023

● M-cap as of February 23, 2024

● Source: ACE Equity, BSE